1. Course Registration Architecture & Priority Enrollment

1.1 Registration System Access & The Student Portal

Western Oak University operates an integrated web-based registration management portal (WOU Student Information Center). All matriculated students are issued a secure academic identifier and authentication token prior to their assigned registration appointment window. System access is strictly partitioned according to accumulated earned credit hours, ensuring that senior degree candidates possess first priority for required capstone and specialized upper-division courses.

Students must log into the portal during their authorized priority registration window. Attempting to access the course catalog or enroll prior to an assigned time-ticket generates an administrative restriction code. Technical support is maintained through the Office of the Registrar and University Computing Services during operational business hours (Monday through Friday, 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM EST).

1.2 Priority Registration Schedule & Class Standing Tiers

Course registration priority is stratified based upon completed semester credit hours officially verified on the institutional transcript at the time registration passes open:

- Tier 1 (Doctoral and Master's Candidates): Monday of Week 10, beginning at 7:00 AM.
- Tier 2 (Graduating Seniors with 90+ earned credits): Tuesday of Week 10, beginning at 7:00 AM.
- Tier 3 (Juniors with 60 to 89 earned credits): Thursday of Week 10, beginning at 7:00 AM.
- Tier 4 (Sophomores with 30 to 59 earned credits): Monday of Week 11, beginning at 7:00 AM.
- Tier 5 (Freshmen with under 30 earned credits): Wednesday of Week 11, beginning at 7:00 AM.
- Tier 6 (Non-degree, audit, and visiting students): Friday of Week 11, beginning at 9:00 AM.

Students who miss their designated initial priority window may register during the Open Enrollment Period, which remains active continuously through the official term census date.

2. Credit Limits, Enrollment Ceilings, and Course Overloads

2.1 Standard Credit Allowances and Term Capacities

The registration portal enforces automated software guardrails on total semester credit hours. All full-time undergraduate students are encouraged to maintain a recommended progression pace of 15 to 16 credits per semester to ensure timely graduation within four academic years.

The maximum credit load for undergraduate students during a regular semester is 21 credits. The automated registration software permits students in good academic standing to add coursework up to this 21-credit ceiling directly through the online self-service interface without requiring individual administrative approval or departmental advisor overrides. Full-time tuition covers courses up to the maximum load; credits attempted beyond statutory thresholds may incur supplemental per-credit charges.

2.2 Overload Petition Requirements (Exceeding 21 Credits)

Any undergraduate student seeking to register for 22 or more semester credits in an Autumn or Spring term must complete the formal Academic Overload Petition Protocol. Approval requires the following verifiable qualifications:

1. Attainment of Senior academic standing (minimum 90 earned credits).
2. A cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of at least 3.50 over the preceding two academic semesters.
3. Explicit written endorsement from the student's Faculty Academic Advisor and the Department Chairperson.
4. Final executive authorization from the Associate Dean of Academic Affairs.

Under no circumstances may any undergraduate student enroll in more than 24 credit hours in a single academic semester. Overload petitions submitted after the second instructional day of the semester will be rejected automatically.

3. Add/Drop Framework, Waitlist Protocols, and Schedule Adjustments

3.1 The Add/Drop Schedule Modification Window

Students may modify their semester course schedules during the designated Add/Drop Period. The add/drop window opens on the first day of instructional classes and concludes promptly at 11:59 PM on the fifth instructional business day (the official University Census Date).

During this five-day timeframe:
- Courses dropped are completely expunged from the student's permanent academic record, leaving no transcript notation or grade entry.
- Tuition charges for dropped courses are recalculated at a 100% refund credit, provided the student remains within full-time billing parameters or part-time tuition scales.
- Students may add open course sections via the self-service registration portal without securing instructor signatures, provided all prerequisite requirements are verified by the automated system.

3.2 Automated Waitlist Protocol and Seat Offers

When a designated course section achieves full capacity, eligible students may opt onto an automated electronic waitlist. Waitlist positions are queued in strict chronological order of student enrollment request.

If a registered student relinquishes a seat, an automated system notification is dispatched via official university email to the next queued waitlist candidate. The notified student is granted an absolute reservation window of exactly twenty-four (24) hours from the email dispatch timestamp to finalize registration. If the student fails to claim the seat within the 24-hour window, the reservation is permanently forfeited and automatically reallocated to the subsequent candidate in line.

4. Prerequisites, Enforced Corequisites, and Registration Holds

4.1 Prerequisite Enforcement and Automated Checking

All course prerequisites published in the Western Oak University Undergraduate Catalog are enforced by the automated registration system. A prerequisite course must be completed with a minimum grade of 'C' (2.00) or higher to satisfy qualification requirements, unless a higher grade threshold is expressly stipulated in the course syllabus.

Concurrent enrollment in a prerequisite course during a preceding term allows conditional pre-registration. However, if the final posted grade in the prerequisite course is below a 'C', the automated system generates a prerequisite deficiency flag and drops the student from the advanced course prior to the first instructional meeting.

4.2 Administrative Holds and Registration Restrictions

Registration holds prevent students from adding or adjusting course sections until specific institutional requirements are resolved. Common holds include:

- Advising Hold: Placed on all first-year undergraduates and students on academic probation, requiring formal consultation with an assigned faculty advisor.
- Financial/Bursar Hold: Placed when an outstanding student account balance exceeds $200.00.
- Health Immunization Hold: Placed for missing mandatory MMR, meningitis, or tuberculosis clinical documentation.
- Library and Parking Holds: Placed for unreturned equipment or unpaid campus transit violations.

Students can view active holds and resolution instructions within the Student Portal 'Holds and Alerts' dashboard.

5. Course Withdrawals, Audit Regulations, and Special Registrations

5.1 Individual Course Withdrawal ('W' Grade Period)

Following the expiration of the official Add/Drop Census Date (end of Week 1), a student may no longer drop a course without transcript notation. Instead, students must execute an Individual Course Withdrawal through the Registrar portal.

The Course Withdrawal window extends from Week 2 through the conclusion of Week 10 of the instructional semester. A course withdrawal results in a recorded grade of 'W' on the permanent academic transcript. The 'W' designation bears zero quality points and does not affect cumulative GPA calculations, though it counts as attempted credits for Satisfactory Academic Progress (SAP) calculations. No course withdrawals are permitted after Week 10 under any circumstances.

5.2 Auditing Courses and Independent Study Enrollments

Students wishing to attend lectures without receiving academic credit or grade evaluations may petition for Course Audit status during the first two weeks of instruction. Audit requests require written consent from the course instructor and department chair.

Audited courses are billed at regular tuition rates and appear on transcripts with the grade of 'AUD'. Auditors are expected to maintain regular attendance but are exempt from completing examinations, term papers, and laboratory projects. Audit status cannot be converted to credit-bearing enrollment after the conclusion of the second instructional week.